

BHOPAL | In His Own Words



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Congress veteran Arjun Singh is busy doing what top politicians usually do in the twilight of their long political careers. Denied a berth in UPA-II on the grounds of his failing health, the 79-year-old Rajput leader from Madhya Pradesh is now busy sourcing material for an autobiography. The former Union HRD minister, currently on an extended sojourn in Madhya Pradesh, wrote to all the senior journalists of the state a couple of months ago seeking printed material that could be incorporated in the tome on his life. While his once-formidable camp in the state Congress believes rehabilitation is just round the bend in the form of a gubernatorial job, Singh has avoided speaking to the media on political issues during his stay. Now what's remains on the gas is the meat in the autobiography: will it be a bland offering or a spicy goulash?

by Ambresh Mishra

MUMBAI | Smart Sniff

Training dogs for security purposes could soon be passé. IIT Mumbai is developing electronic sniffer dogs to check for IEDs, RDX and other kind of explosives. These devices, called "e-dogs", will detect the faintest of scents and their in-built



sensors would instantly zero in on a person carrying explosives. To develop e-dogs, IIT will work with the Terminal Ballistics Research Lab of the Defence Research and Development Organisation, Chandigarh, and the Madras Atomic Power Station at Kalpakkam near Chennai. E-dogs will be inexpensive too, as each sensor is expected to cost no more than Rs 1,000.

by Harsha Bhat

DELHI | Green Jam

The 2010 Auto Expo had at least seven efficient 'green' passenger cars out on stage. But the eco-friendly cars won't be seen in India anytime soon due to a range of infrastructure issues. Here are the challenges that each class will face in India.

CNG CARS	HYBRID VEHICLES	ELECTRIC/ PLUG-IN VEHICLES	BIOFUEL VEHICLES
• Inadequate refuelling stations across cities. • Bulky CNG kits often eat into boot space of cars.	• High initial cost due to non-availability of locally developed technology. Import duties and taxes add to vehicle cost. No tax subsidies from the Government. • In case of fuel cells, doubts loom over the reliability, durability and performance under various conditions. • No safety standards yet on hydrogen gas.	• Lack of recharging stations. No coordination between industry and the government for infrastructure. • Barring Delhi and Chandigarh, no tax sops on electric vehicles in other cities.	• Bio-diesel's lower energy content can reduce car performance by 5-8 per cent. • The fuel itself can't be kept for more than a few days as it degrades the car tank. • No clarity on biofuel policy.

by Nandini Vaish



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